PROJECT GUIDE

GitHub Copilot app for Beginners

A hands-on course about directing, supervising, and validating AI coding-agent work—with a small web app to practice on.

What this project is

This repository teaches learners how to use the GitHub Copilot app as a workspace for agent-driven development. The focus is not just generating code: learners practice choosing a session mode, providing useful context, reviewing changes, checking evidence, and keeping human judgment in the loop.

The course connects agent work to familiar development activities: working with issues and pull requests, running tests, previewing a web app, and deciding what should or should not be automated.

> **In one sentence:** The course teaches agent workflows; the Book App Web gives learners a consistent, low-risk project for practicing those workflows.

Course path

The numbered chapters build from setup toward increasingly customized and automated workflows.

00 · Setup
Prepare the course environment.

01 · Tour the App
Explore chats, sessions, modes, models, and settings.

02 · Sessions, Worktrees, and Context
Start isolated work and attach relevant context.

03 · Development and GitHub Workflows
Review, test, preview, and move work through issues and PRs.

04 · Skills and Custom Agents
Customize agent behavior for focused tasks.

05 · MCP Servers and Plugins
Connect tools and use plugin capabilities.

06 · Canvases
Keep plans, progress, and evidence visible.

07 · Automations
Create and schedule repeatable workflows.

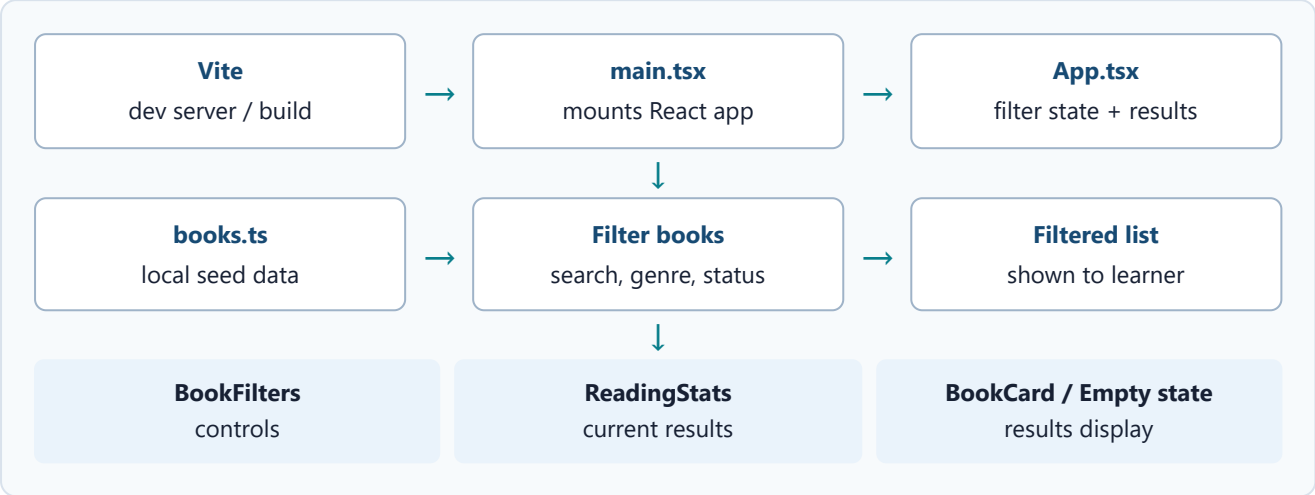
Learning pattern: chapters introduce a concept, relate it to a “recording studio” analogy, then give learners practical exercises and takeaways.

Project overview · Based on the repository README and Book App Web sample documentation

THE PRACTICE PROJECT

Book App Web architecture

The canonical sample is a small, frontend-only book collection built with React, TypeScript, and Vite. Its seed data is local: there is no backend, database, or external API.



What learners can practice

- Search by book title or author.
- Filter by genre and read/unread status.
- Check statistics for the currently displayed books.
- Review code changes, tests, and browser behavior.
- Practice issue and pull-request workflows using course scenarios.

Where to look

- `src/App.tsx` — filter state and matching logic.
- `src/data/books.ts` — book types and sample data.
- `src/components/` — filters, stats, and book cards.
- `src/tests/` — filtering and statistics tests.
- `src/styles/app.css` — app styling.

Run and validate the sample

```
npm install
npm run dev -- --host 127.0.0.1 --port 5173
npm test -- --run
npm run build
```

The course uses the sample to teach a repeatable loop: give an agent a focused task, inspect its changes, run checks, preview the result, and decide whether the evidence is good enough.

Architecture is intentionally simple so learners can focus on the Copilot app and development workflow.